

Practice Paper 6 — Answer Scheme

Paper 2 — Comprehension

Sections B & C

Note to teachers and students

- Marks are awarded for **meaning**, not for exact words. Where a quotation is required, it has been indicated in inverted commas.
- Where the question asks for **own words**, a candidate who lifts directly from the text receives **zero** for that mark unless the lifted phrase is unavoidable.
- For language and tone questions, accept any reasonable alternative that clearly fits the textual evidence.

Section B — Text 3 Answer Scheme [20 marks]

Q1. [2] — Relationship with her home country while abroad

1 mark for identifying that she **remembered her country with affection** / **kept it carefully in her memory**.

1 mark for noting that she **rarely engaged with it directly** — it was stored away and only **occasionally** taken out and thought about; her memory had grown **idealised** and **out of date**.

Sample answer: The phrase suggests that the narrator **treasured** the memory of her country and **protected it carefully**, but did not actually return to it; she revisited it only in her thoughts, so the country in her head had become a **fond, slightly faded image** rather than the real place.

Q2. [2] — Two details showing the village has changed

1 mark each for any two of:

- The lane is **wider** than she remembered.
- The mango tree that leaned over the gate is **gone**.
- A **bright municipal blue streetlight** has been installed where the tree once stood.
- She feels “like a guest who has arrived... at the wrong house” (showing the village no longer feels like hers).

Reject: “the bus set me down at the foot of the lane” — this is not a change.

Q3. [2] — “Dry and surprisingly cool, the way old paper is cool”

1 mark for understanding that the aunt has **aged** / **become physically frail**; her skin has lost its warmth and moisture.

1 mark for the **simile**: comparing her hands to **old paper** suggests **fragility**, **thinness**, and the gentle **worn quality** of someone who is no longer young.

Q4. [2] — “You have eaten” as a welcome

1 mark for noting that it is a **familiar, customary form of greeting** in their dialect — almost a **ritual / habitual phrase** rather than a real enquiry.

1 mark for explaining the **effect**: the unchanged greeting **anchors** the narrator back in her old life and is delivered with **quiet, undemonstrative affection** — the aunt does not need elaborate words to welcome her.

Q5. [2] — The old well

(a) [1]: As a child, she had thought / assumed that **the well would always be there**.

(b) [1]: She now sees this belief as “stupid” because she **now knows that nothing in the village stays the same** — the well has been filled in and replaced by mains water; **change is inevitable** and her childhood assumption was **naive**.

Q6. [3] — Complicated feelings about being home (language question)

1 mark for identifying that the narrator feels **both connected and estranged / affection mixed with awkwardness**.

1 mark each for **two** clearly quoted and explained details (max 2).

Accept any two of:

- “as one meets an old friend across a noisy room” — **simile** suggesting **recognition and affection**, but also **distance / difficulty in reconnecting**.
- “with recognition, with affection, and with a small awkwardness” — the **tricolon** names her conflicted emotions plainly: she knows the food, loves it, but no longer fits it.
- “my own mouth, accustomed for fifteen years to other tastes” — emphasises how **her body itself** has changed; she has become a partial stranger to her own childhood food.
- “I had once found her authority irritating. I would have given a great deal... to be irritated by her again” — the **reversal** shows tender **regret**: what once annoyed her now feels precious.

Each detail must be **quoted** and **explained**; mere lifting without explanation = ½ mark.

Q7. [2] — “The way one walks past a house one used to live in”

1 mark — The comparison suggests **a sense of disconnection**: the place is **familiar** but **no longer hers**; she has no claim on it.

1 mark — It also suggests a **quiet, restrained sadness / nostalgia** — she does not stop or react dramatically, but feels the loss of what used to belong to her.

Q8. [1] — Why she did not recognise herself

1 mark — Any **one** of:

- Her **hair was cut** in a way “no one in this village wore their hair.”
- She was “**rather well dressed**” — dressed differently from the villagers.
- She looked “**tall, and tired**” — i.e., a stranger’s appearance, not the girl she had been.

Q9. [2] — Literary device in the reflection sentence

1 mark — Identification: **personification** of the reflection (treating the reflection as a separate person with “polite, careful interest”) **or dramatic irony / self-distancing**. (Accept also:

metaphor of self as a stranger.)

1 mark — Effect: it conveys how **estranged** the narrator now feels from her own identity — she has been away so long that even her own image meets her with the **cool politeness of a stranger**.

Q10. [2] — Home as a once-spoken language (own words)

1 mark — She suggests that her **sense of belonging** is **no longer automatic**: she used to be at home here without thinking, just as one once spoke a language fluently.

1 mark — She will now have to **re-learn** what home means **slowly and deliberately**, paying close attention — belonging is no longer effortless but a **careful, conscious effort**.

Reject answers that list “speak more carefully” without rewording.

Q11. [1] — Tone of the final paragraph

1 mark — Any **one** of: **reflective, wistful, bittersweet, resigned, quietly melancholic**. (Reject: **angry, bitter, cheerful** — these miss the subdued, contemplative quality.)

Section C — Text 4 Answer Scheme [25 marks]

Q12. [2] — What a “ghost kitchen” is

1 mark for understanding it is a **commercial cooking space / kitchen with no customer-facing dining area** (no dining room, no waiters, often no street sign).

1 mark for understanding its **purpose**: it **exists only to fulfil orders placed through food-delivery apps**.

Q13. [2] — Why a dining room looks like “waste”

1 mark — A dining room requires **expensive frontage, waiting staff, and high rent on a prime street**, all of which cost money.

1 mark — Yet, in the investor’s view, **only the kitchen actually produces revenue** — so the dining room is seen as paying for something that does not directly earn income.

Q14. [2] — Two ways COVID-19 accelerated ghost kitchens

1 mark each for any two of:

- It **forced restaurants to close their dining rooms for months**, so many **pivoted to delivery-only operation**.
- Many traditional restaurants **closed permanently**, leaving space in the market.
- Many **new delivery-only “brands”** were launched, **without ceremony**, from **industrial estates** on the edge of town.

Q15. [2] — “A failed concept costs almost nothing...”

1 mark — It makes the model **low-risk**: an entrepreneur can experiment with a new restaurant idea cheaply, and lose very little if it fails.

1 mark — It makes the model **highly scalable**: a successful idea can be **quickly copied** (“cloned”) across many cities, promising **rapid growth and large rewards**.

Q16. [2] — Inverted commas around “brands” and “restaurant”

1 mark — The inverted commas show the writer is **quoting the industry’s own terms** but **not fully accepting them**; he is **distancing himself** from them.

1 mark — They suggest he sees these “brands” and “restaurants” as **misleading labels** — they look like real, independent restaurants to the customer but are in fact **marketing names** attached to anonymous kitchens. (Accept: **scepticism / mild irony**.)

Q17. [2] — Why Paris and Toronto consider new rules (own words)

1 mark — Because **ghost-kitchen brands on apps are designed to look like genuine independent restaurants**, even though several may share a single industrial unit.

1 mark — Customers **cannot easily tell the difference**, so the cities want apps to be **required to disclose / declare** when a “restaurant” is in fact a ghost-kitchen brand.

Reject answers that lift “designed to look exactly like independent restaurants” without rewording.

Q18. [2] — Riders “squeezed at the other end of the chain”

1 mark — The **metaphor** “squeezed” suggests riders are **under pressure / exploited / given very little room to negotiate**.

1 mark — “The other end of the chain” suggests they are **at the bottom** of the system: while the operator at one end enjoys low costs and high scale, the **rider at the delivery end** absorbs the costs — **no fixed contract, paid per delivery, exposed to weather, traffic and the algorithm**.

Q19. [2] — Contrast between “public life” and “delivery loading bay”

1 mark — “A piece of public life” suggests a **shared, civic space** where people meet, celebrate, argue and pass time — something **socially valuable** beyond its commercial function.

1 mark — “Just a delivery loading bay” reduces the street to a **purely functional, transactional** space, used only for **picking up parcels**. The contrast emphasises that what is being **lost** is not just shops but the **social fabric** of the neighbourhood.

Q20. [2] — Why he concedes the point about young cooks

1 mark — It shows **balance and fairness** — he acknowledges that ghost kitchens have **real, positive uses** and that his criticism is not absolute.

1 mark — It **strengthens his overall argument**: by admitting the genuine benefits, he makes his later concerns about food culture and workers seem **more measured** and therefore **more persuasive**, rather than one-sided.

Q21. [1] — Tone of the final sentence

1 mark — Any **one** of: **cautionary, thoughtful, measured, urging / appealing, gently warning**. (Reject: **angry, despairing** — these miss the deliberative, choice-oriented quality.)

Q22. Summary [13 marks total: 6 content + 7 style]

Content points (½ mark each, max 6 marks). **Eight available content points; candidates should aim for all 8.**

Advantages of ghost kitchens for the businesses (Paragraph 3):

1. **Rent** in an industrial park is far **cheaper** than rent on a main street.
2. **Staff costs** fall sharply — no servers are needed and the kitchen can be **smaller**.
3. **Several “brands”** can share **one kitchen and one staff**, marketed as separate restaurants on apps.
4. Menus can be **tested cheaply and dropped quickly**; failed concepts cost little, while successful ones can be **scaled to many cities**.

Concerns for workers, traditional restaurants and food culture (Paragraphs 4–6):

5. Traditional restaurants must compete with **invisible kitchens** that carry **no front-of-house, decor or street rent**, and are often **disguised** as independent restaurants on apps.
6. Workers lose **varied roles** (server, host, bartender, manager) and the tips and standing that go with them; kitchen work itself becomes **faster and more pressured**.
7. Delivery **riders** face **insecure, contract-less work**, exposed to weather, traffic and the **algorithm**.

8. Streets lose their **social function** as places of public life — courting, celebrating, sheltering — and become mere **delivery loading bays**.

Sample full-marks summary (78 words):

For the businesses that run them, ghost kitchens offer much lower rent, smaller payrolls and the freedom to operate several app-only brands from one site, testing menus cheaply and scaling successful ones rapidly. Yet traditional restaurants are undercut by these hidden kitchens, often disguised as independents. Cooks lose varied, public-facing roles, while delivery riders work without contracts, exposed to weather and algorithms. Streets, once places of shared social life, risk becoming mere collection points for parcels.

Length count: 78 words from “For” onwards.

— END OF ANSWER SCHEME —